



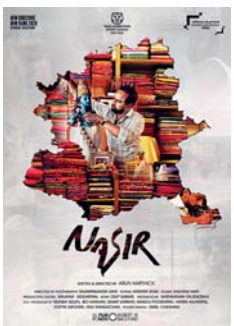
CINEMA

MAKING WAVES AT MoMA

The new Indian indie gets showcased in a month-long festival at New York's Museum of Modern Art

The Museum of Modern Art (MoMA) distinguishes itself from other visual art museums by taking film as seriously as it does sculpture or painting. MoMA has also long had a keen interest in Indian cinema, especially beyond the mainstream. In 1955, it hosted the world premiere of *Pather Panchali*, the debut of a then-unknown Satyajit Ray. Since 1972, award-winning Indian filmmakers such as Mani Kaul, Adoor Gopalakrishnan and Ketan Mehta have featured at the annual New Directors/New Films festival.

With *India Now* in 2007 and *The New India* in 2009, MoMA presented a wider mix of the popular and the critically-acclaimed. Dibakar Banerjee, Vishal Bhardwaj and Zoya Akhtar jostled with older festival favourites





MADE IN INDIA (clockwise from top left): a poster for *Bulbul Can Sing*; stills from *A Night of Knowing Nothing* and *The Shepherdess and the Seven Songs*; a poster for *Nasir*.



From the Margins

***Testimony of Ana*, a National Award–winning documentary short, has its sights trained on an Oscar**



In 2019, Sachin Dheeraj, a student of film and media production at the University of Austin, headed to Dang in southern Gujarat to make his pre-thesis film. His subject, he had decided, would be Anaben Pawar, a tribal woman, who, after being accused of witchcraft in 2017, was repeatedly assaulted by men in her village. Earning the trust of a traumatised survivor wasn't easy. For days, Dheeraj and cinematographer Rohin Raveendran Nair didn't turn on their camera. They only listened. "She thought I was from the perpetrator's side and was there to manipulate her," recalls Dheeraj. "I tried to explain that with her permission, I wanted to take her story to the world. I wanted to preserve her memories, immortalise them through the film." Pawar gradually opened up. The result: a 24-minute documentary short called *Testimony of Ana*, which recently won the National Award for best non-feature film and also qualified for the Oscars by winning the top prize at the International Documentary & Short Film Festival of Kerala. The film now releases on MUBI India on September 16.

The most compelling